5 Key Waste Management Rules by Country

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India | United States | Russia | Japan | Australia

India	United States	Russia	Japan	Australia
Bio-Medical Waste Management Rules, 2016 Requires healthcare facilities to segregate biomedical waste into color-coded bags/containers (yellow, red, white, blue) and hand it to authorized Common Bio-medical Waste Treatment Facilities within prescribed timelines.	**CERCLA (Superfund), 1980** Gives EPA authority to identify contaminated sites, compel responsible parties to clean them up, and recover cleanup costs through the Superfund trust.	**National Project 'Ecology'** Sets national targets to raise the share of municipal solid waste that is sorted and processed, and to build a nationwide Comprehensive MSW Management System.	**Home Appliance Recycling Act** Obliges manufacturers and retailers to take back and recycle four categories of home appliances (TVs, refrigerators, washing machines, air conditioners) with consumers paying a recycling fee.	**Australia's Circular Economy Framework, 2024** Sets a national goal to double the circularity rate of the economy from 4.3% to 8.6% by 2035 through better product design and resource recovery.
Plastic Waste Management Rules, 2016 Bans identified single-use plastic items, sets minimum thickness for plastic carry bags, and makes producers/importers/brand owners responsible for collecting back plastic waste (EPR).	**RCRA Subtitle D** Sets minimum federal design, location, and closure standards for municipal and industrial non-hazardous waste landfills; bans open dumping.	**Federal Law No. 89-FZ 'On Production and Consumption Waste' (1998)** Establishes the legal basis for waste classification, licensing of waste-handling activities, and assigns waste management duties to federal, regional, and local authorities.	**Container and Packaging Recycling Act** Requires municipalities to sort-collect containers and packaging waste while manufacturers and users share the cost of recycling it.	**Container Deposit Scheme legislation (state-based)** Requires a refundable deposit on eligible beverage containers, redeemable at collection points, to boost recycling rates (in force in every state/territory).
Hazardous & Other Wastes (Management & Transboundary Movement) Rules, 2016 Requires authorization for generation, storage, and disposal of hazardous waste, and regulates import/export of hazardous waste as per Basel Convention obligations.	**State-level Extended Producer Responsibility laws** States such as California, Oregon, Colorado and Maine require producers of packaging or electronics to fund and manage end-of-life collection and recycling.	**Extended Producer Responsibility Packaging Rules (2025)** Requires manufacturers and importers of packaging to recycle 100% of packaging waste placed on the market, with a penalty eco-fee (2x the shortfall) if targets are missed.	**Plastic Resource Circulation Promotion Law, 2022 (tightened 2025)** Requires businesses to reduce or switch away from 12 categories of single-use plastic items and design products for recyclability.	**Recycling and Waste Reduction Act 2020 (Cth)** Legally underpins the ban on exporting unprocessed waste plastic, paper, glass and tyres and enables national product stewardship schemes.
Solid Waste Management Rules, 2016 (updated 2024/2026) Mandates source segregation of waste into 4 streams (wet, dry, domestic hazardous, sanitary), door-to-door collection, and processing/treatment before landfilling.	**RCRA, 1976** Establishes 'cradle-to-grave' tracking of hazardous waste from generation through transport, treatment, storage, and disposal, requiring manifests at each transfer.	**Federal Law No. 503-FZ (2017)** Waste Reform — Introduced regional operators with exclusive rights to collect, transport, and dispose of municipal solid waste in each federal subject, selected through public tender.	**Waste Management and Public Cleansing Act** The core statute governing collection, transport, treatment, and disposal of both municipal and industrial waste, with prefectural licensing of waste handlers.	**National Waste Policy, 2018** Sets seven national targets, including an 80% average resource recovery rate and a 10% per-person reduction in total waste generated, by 2030.
E-Waste (Management) Rules, 2022 Fixes annual e-waste recycling targets for producers under EPR and mandates portal registration.	**RCRA Subtitle C** Requires generators, transporters, and treatment/storage/disposal facilities (TSDFs) to obtain permits and follow strict hazardous-waste handling and record-keeping standards.	**Resolution No. 1073 (2015)** Environmental Fee Calculation — Sets the formula for the fee owed by producers/importers who don't independently recycle their waste.	**Basic Act on Establishing a Sound Material-Cycle Society, 2001** Sets the national priority order for waste handling (reduce, reuse, recycle, then dispose) that all other recycling laws must follow.	**State/Territory Environment Protection Acts** Primary state-level laws giving EPAs power to license waste facilities, set landfill levies, and enforce waste-handling standards.

Note: Summary reference only; consult official government sources for legal compliance.